

SAMANTHA RADOCCCHIA

Anthropologist working on perceptual security and illicit economies. Field research in Peru, Mexico, Ecuador, Colombia, Israel, and inside two persistent virtual worlds. Named inventor on four granted US patents in identity and provenance.

Focus areas: innovation · AI product and research leadership · open-source intelligence · trust and safety · fraud and financial crime · synthetic media · supply chain provenance

New York, NY · sam@sam-rad.com · linkedin.com/in/samradoofficial · ORCID 0009-0006-9051-3345 · sam-rad.com/cv

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Perceptual security: how synthetic media and cognitive manipulation alter what individuals and institutions are able to treat as real. Convergence in illicit economies, where trafficking, laundering, and contraband share corridors and infrastructure. Provenance and authentication of physical and digital objects. Identity formation in simulated and virtual landscapes. National myth and collective consciousness.

EDUCATION

2013	MA, Media, Culture, and Communication: Technology & Society · New York University Thesis: <i>iCreated a Monster: Consumer Alienation and the Corporate Alien-Nation in the Digital Age</i>
2011	BA, Anthropology and English (Linguistics) · Colgate University Anthropology thesis: <i>Constructing Identity in Virtual and Simulated Landscapes: Ethnography of Second Life</i> English thesis: <i>Laundering Utopia for May 1968: The rhetorical switch from revolution to desire in 1960s–1970s Utopian and Science Fiction</i>

FIELDWORK

2024 – PRESENT	Mindo, Ecuador State actors and infrastructure in illicit economies: how public institutions and physical logistics are co-opted or captured.
2023	Medellín, Colombia Use of marketplace dating applications by transnational organized crime groups for recruitment and targeting. Platform ethnography and offline follow-through.
2022 – 2023	Pisac, Peru and the Yucatán, Mexico Convergence in illicit trade: where human trafficking and forced labor, money laundering, and contraband movement meet in the same corridors and the same local economies.
2020 – 2024	SamRad.AI · autoethnography Built a working cognitive, vocal, and visual likeness of herself, trained on fifteen years of her own commonplace books, published writing, and public output, then studied what it was able to do: hold opinions on material it had never seen, and convince colleagues and family on a video call. The most capable version was withheld from release. The project produced the questions that became her work on perceptual security.
2020 – 2021	Discord · virtual Cognitive and narrative attack vectors through perceptual communities of practice. Case study on Pastel QAnon.
2009 – 2010	Israel Independent research on the role of national myth in establishing collective consciousness and identity.

2009 – 2010

Second Life · virtual

Constructing Identity in Virtual and Simulated Landscapes: an ethnography of Second Life. Among the first anthropologists to conduct sustained participant observation inside a persistent virtual world.

CURRENT PRACTICE

2025 – PRESENT

Co-Founder, Illicit Shadows, LLC · Washington, DC

Investigative documentary series on illicit economies, with David M. Luna. Custodian of **MISTIC** (Illicit Shadows Media, Technology, and Innovation Convergence), an institute mapping the convergence of organized crime, emerging technology, and global threat networks, and home to **Project Helix**, an AI-based predictive convergence system. Partners: International Coalition Against Illicit Economies and RADOc.

Briefings, 2024 to present: MISTIC findings on convergent crime, illicit finance, and synthetic media presented to delegations at the UN General Assembly, the OECD, and INTERPOL.

2024 – PRESENT

Founder, RADOc

Media studio working in narrative futurism. Producer of Illicit Shadows.

2017 – PRESENT

Sam Rad, Keynote Speaker

Keynotes on five continents to governments, Fortune 500 companies, trade associations, and international organizations. Represented by Executive Speakers Bureau.

PUBLICATIONS

2025

Radical Next: Reclaiming Your Humanity in a Post-Human World · Amplify Publishing · #1 Amazon bestseller

2019

Bitcoin Pizza: The No-Bullshit Guide to Blockchain · Lioncrest · #1 Amazon bestseller on release

2017 – 2021

Contributing writer, **Forbes**. Over fifty pieces on emerging technology and society. Also Fast Company, Worth, HuffPost, Inc., IBTimes, CoinDesk.

ONGOING

Curated primary-source guides on AI-driven fraud, clinical AI, and provenance.

CITED IN

REGULATOR

US Securities and Exchange Commission · Commissioner Hester M. Peirce, remarks before the Small Business Capital Formation Advisory Committee, 8 May 2020.

REFERENCE WORK

The Routledge Social Science Handbook of AI · edited by Anthony Elliott · Routledge, 2021

ACADEMIC PRESS

Regulation of Cryptocurrencies and Blockchain Technologies · Rosario Girasa · Palgrave Macmillan, 2018

CASE STUDY

Rethink: Smashing the Myths of Women in Business · Andi Simon · Chapter 10, "Myth 10: Women Don't Belong in IT" · 2021

INVENTION AND STANDARDS

US 11,354,676 B2

[Granted] Open Registry for Identity of Things

Granted 7 June 2022. Filed 3 June 2016. First-named inventor. Assignee Chronicled, Inc.

US 2018/0108024

[Filed] Open Registry for Provenance and Tracking of Goods in the Supply Chain

Filed 16 October 2017. Named inventor. Chronicled, Inc.

US 2018/0032759

[Filed] Open Registry for Human Identification

Filed 6 October 2017. First-named inventor. Chronicled, Inc.

Four granted in total, all first-named inventor, all assigned to Chronicled, Inc. The three not listed above are variants of the same Identity of Things filing: US 11,113,699 B2 and US 11,107,088 B2, continuations granted 2021, and US 10,210,527 B2, Including Social Record Feature, granted 2019. Three further applications were filed and not granted: Including Sealed Materials (US 2018/0019872), Including Item Location Feature (US 2016/0358158), and Including Tamperproof Tags (US 2016/0358184).

PROTOCOL WORK Early protocol work at Chronicled, open sourced into the Ethereum standards, predating and paralleling ERC-721.

VENTURES AND APPOINTMENTS

2020 – 2022	CEO & Co-Founder, NYOUM Ltd · London Founded and led an applied AI company from zero to product. Built YOUM.AI, an AI-native video communication platform, and the research function behind it: natural language processing, large language models, machine translation, speech and facial recognition, and biometrics. Hired the team, set the research agenda, took the product to market in the US, then led the pivot and the handover to a regional CEO. Built: an AI research function from scratch · one platform to market · the pivot decision and succession
2014 – 2019	Co-Founder, Chronicled · San Francisco Chief Product Officer, 2014 to 2018 · Chief Marketing Officer, 2018 to 2019 Venture-backed enterprise software company, \$30M+ raised, 50+ staff. Founded the company's innovation infrastructure: the Blockchain x IoT Laboratory, the Enterprise Protocol Lab, and Blockchain for Better. Evaluated 1,500+ use cases across consumer and enterprise markets, incubated 20+ industry ecosystems, and brought 10+ products to market across authentication, cold chain, secure sealing, and track and trace. Built the MediLedger network (Pfizer, Genentech, AmerisourceBergen, McKesson, Cardinal Health) and Responsible Gold. Founding member of the Enterprise Ethereum Alliance, Trusted IoT Alliance, and MOBI. Educated 250+ Fortune 500 C-suite executives and board members. Hired the initial team of 50+ designers and engineers, and acquired an additive manufacturing company to bring hardware in house. Illicit markets addressed: counterfeit pharmaceuticals and diverted product, counterfeit luxury goods and apparel, illicit precious metals and minerals, gray-market automotive parts, and food fraud.
2011 – 2014	Founder & CEO, Stunable · New York Built machine-learning recommendation systems for e-commerce, including the first-of-its-kind "fashion genome project" mapping consumer taste. Pioneered single-click inventory integration; the synchronization engine was used by 10,000+ merchants. Raised the funding, ran the company, and negotiated a multi-year docuseries contract with NBC as part of go-to-market. Markets: fashion and direct-to-consumer. Built: a taste-mapping ML system · an inventory engine at 10,000+ merchant scale · a network television partnership

CONCURRENT APPOINTMENTS

2016 – 2023	Faculty, Singularity University · Santa Clara, CA Speaking and executive leadership training, held alongside her founder roles and degrees. Designed and delivered executive innovation programs on technological, socio-cultural, and geopolitical convergence. Built workshops and prototyping formats used at global summits, and ran foresight sessions for Fortune 100 leadership teams on distributed ledgers, machine learning, advanced manufacturing, and extended realities. Built: executive program curriculum · prototyping and foresight workshop formats · keynote practice to audiences of 3,000+
-------------	--

2011 – PRESENT

Founder, Radical Next · personal consulting and R&D practice

Started in college and run alongside every role since. An innovation vehicle for work with Fortune 500 companies, startups, non-profits, and governments. Projects: decentralized manufacturing and IP storage with 3D printers for a Fortune 100 industrial manufacturer; values and ingredient-based recommendation with decentralized shopper data for a global consumer goods company; identity and currency deployment in a Venezuelan and Brazilian refugee camp; secure file storage for journalists and sources in conflict zones; tracking of volatile substances and chemicals for a Fortune 50 energy company and a global oil major; autonomous vehicle delivery and authentication; large-scale virtual world architecture and asset protocol for a blockchain gaming platform.

TRAINING AND CERTIFICATION

2025	Cybersecurity · Google
2024	Open-source intelligence · Bellingcat
2013	Software engineering · Flatiron School
2012	Organizational behavior · King's College London

ADVISORY

OECD	Counterfeit and illicit market data · Commissioned briefing, March 2026
FEDERAL RESERVE BANK OF CHICAGO	Distributed ledger applications in payments · Commissioned briefing, September 2021
UNITED NATIONS	Emerging technology and illicit trade · Working Group on Sustainable Production and Consumption, 2018
WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM	Blockchain and supply chain provenance · Commissioned briefing, 2018

AWARDS

2019	Newsweek Blockchain Impact Award · to Chronicled for MediLedger
2017	Forbes 30 Under 30 · Enterprise Technology

SKILLS AND METHODS

TECHNICAL	AI and large language models · agentic design · natural language processing · distributed ledgers and applied cryptography · Python, Ruby, Solidity, JavaScript · IoT and hardware design · additive manufacturing
METHOD	Ethnography and participant observation · open-source intelligence · foresight and scenario work · product and protocol design
CERTIFICATIONS	EMT-B and remote EMT · skydiving license · student pilot · advanced open-water diver
EARLIER	Competitive skydiver, Connecticut Parachutists, 2006–2010: 700+ jumps, four-way formation, competed internationally. Assistant Director, <i>Othello</i> , Theatre for a New Audience, 2009.